



Custer torching the Valley

War artist Alfred Waud sketched General George Custer's division retiring from the Mount Jackson area on October 7, 1864, burning agricultural resources along the way.

The Battle of Cedar Creek

Secure in his control of the lower valley, and believing Early's divisions to have withdrawn, Sheridan departed for Washington. But Early was closer than Sheridan realized, and had lost none of his audacity. Though outnumbered four to one, he still hoped to prevent Sheridan from reinforcing Grant, and planned a surprise attack on the Union army encamped behind Cedar Creek, 12 miles (19km) south of Winchester.